

Qualitative and Archival Methods Grad Course Offerings and Subfield Requirements.

Updated January 2026.

Core Courses

PLSC 5050b. *Qualitative Field Research*.

PLSC 5090. *Philosophy of Science for the Study of Politics*.

PLSC 5220a/b. *Historical Approaches to the Study of Politics*.

PLSC 5230a/b. *Mixed Methods Research*.

PLSC 7990b. *Micro-historical Analysis in Social Science Research*.

PLSC 5270. *From Concept to Measure*.

Workshops. N/A

Subfield Requirements

Students may only qualify in Qualitative and Archival Methods by coursework.

To qualify by coursework, students must take three courses:

Students who enter the program in the Fall 2026 term or after must take *Qualitative Field Research* (PLSC 5050b) and any two of the other core courses listed above.

Students who entered the program before the Fall 2026 term must take three distinct courses: 5050 or 5090; either 5220, 7990, or 5090; *and* either 5230 or 5090. (Students may opt to fulfill the requirements for students entering in Fall 2026 if they prefer but must inform the QAM subfield coordinator, the Graduate Registrar and the Director of Graduate Studies.)

In addition, all students must write a paper using qualitative methods in the context of one of their three courses that shows a strong command of the methodological approaches in the field. It must be approved by the course instructor as meeting the subfield paper requirement. The student should ensure that the instructor has sent the approval to the Graduate Registrar and the Director of Graduate Studies.

